

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 4
 ♥ 9 6 5
 ♦ K 9 6 2
 ♣ Q J 10 9

♠ A J 10 8 5 2

♥ K J 4

♦ A 8

♣ K 6



♠ K 6

♥ 8 7 3

♦ Q J 10 4

♣ A 8 3 2

♠ Q 9 3

♥ A Q 10 2

♦ 7 5 3

♣ 7 5 4

West	North	East	South
	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			

4 ♠ by North

Lead: ♦ Q

play ♣s from his side of the table without handing you a trick. Whatever else he plays you win, pull trumps, and discard a ♣ loser on dummy's fourth ♥.

North is to play 4 ♠. East leads the ♦ Q. West plays the ♦ 9.

Losers: ♠=1 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 4

On the plus side dummy has an extra ♥ winner on which you could discard a loser from your hand. The danger is that when you take the trump finesse, East might win the ♠ K and put his partner in the lead with the ♦ K for a ♣ play through your ♣ K.

To prevent that from happening all you have to do is hold up on the first ♦. You have to lose one trick in the suit no matter what, so lose it right now to East, the Safe Hand. East continues with another ♦ which you win.

You go over to dummy with a ♥ and play the ♠ Q, letting it ride. East wins with his ♠ K, but cannot

play ♣s from his side of the table without handing you a trick. Whatever else he plays you win, pull trumps,

and discard a ♣ loser on dummy's fourth ♥.

At notrump you usually hold up to exhaust one player of a suit so he cannot lead that suit back to his partner.

At suit contracts the most common reason for a hold-up is to keep the Danger Hand from getting the lead.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 6 3
 ♥ K Q 10 8 5
 ♦ K 10 9
 ♣ 7 2

♠ K Q 9

♥ A 3 2

♦ 7 5 3

♣ Q 9 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 5 2

♥ 9 6

♦ A J 6 2

♣ 10 8 3

♠ A 8 4

♥ J 7 4

♦ Q 8 4

♣ A K J 6

West	North	East	South
Pass	3NT		1NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♥K

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♥K.

Winners: ♠=3 ♥=1 ♦=0 ♣=4 Total = 8

Unless there is a miracle in the ♦s, (or a defensive error), you can't get a trick in that suit. But you have a chance for a second ♥ trick.

It's the Bath Coup again, just dressed up a little differently.

Let West hold the first trick, playing the ♥7 from your hand to conceal the ♥4 in the hope that West will continue the suit. If he does you have your ninth trick - if he doesn't, good luck.

Compare this Bath Coup to the one in Deal 10.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 4
 ♥ Q J 9 8
 ♦ J 8 6 2
 ♣ 8 7 2

♠ 10 9 5 3

♥ A K 4

♦ A Q 7

♣ K 6 3



♠ K J 8 7 2

♥ 10 7 5

♦ 10 9 4

♣ A 5

♠ A 6

♥ 6 3 2

♦ K 5 3

♣ Q J 10 9 4

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♠ 7

will play his honor, win the trick, and clear the suit by leading his small x. If East can get in with the ♣ A he will run the ♠ s.

But what will West do if you play dummy's ♠ A? If he plays his small one the ♠ suit will block. If he unblocks his honor card then your ♠ 10 9 5 3 will provide a second stopper in the suit. So you go up with dummy's ♠ A and guarantee the contract.

A tough finish that needs some real visualization to get right.

Of course from now on you will recognize it.

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♠ 7.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=2 ♦=3 ♣=0 Total = 6

It's pretty clear that your extra tricks are going to have to come from the ♣ suit. The danger here is that East may have a 5-card ♠ suit that he can establish and the ♣ A as an entry. So what is the best approach, hold up or not hold up?

To answer that question you must think about East's lead. Since he did not lead the ♠ K you know he doesn't have a suit headed by K Q J. So you can visualize West sitting there with a doubleton honor in ♠ s. It might be ♠ K x, ♠ Q x or ♠ J x, but it is surely one of those three.

Think what West will do if you duck in dummy. He